

Education

- 2025 - **PhD, Computer Science, Northeastern University, Boston, MA**
Advisor: Lace Padilla
- 2023 - 2024 **MS, Computer Science, University of Washington, Seattle, WA**
Supervisor: Noah A. Smith
- 2018 - 2023 **BS, Computer Science + BA, Comparative History of Ideas, University of Washington, Seattle, WA**
Magna Cum Laude

Publications

- [5] Untangling Trust, Transparency, and Uncertainty in Machine Learning
Kai Nylund, Shani Spivak, Dakuo Wang, Lace Padilla
To appear in AIES 2026
- [4] [MatplotAlt: a Python Library for Adding Alt Text to Matplotlib Figures in Computational Notebooks](#)
Kai Nylund, Jennifer Mankoff, Venkatesh Potluri
EuroVis 2025
- [3] [Time is Encoded in the Weights of Finetuned Language Models](#)
Kai Nylund, Suchin Gururangan, Noah A. Smith
ACL 2024
- [2] [Brain-wide representations of prior information in mouse decision-making](#)
Charles Findling, Felix Hubert, **International Brain Laboratory**
Nature 2025
- [1] [A brain-wide map of neural activity during complex behaviour](#)
International Brain Laboratory (50+ authors)
Nature 2025

Research Experience

- 2025 - **Graduate Researcher, Khoury Visualization Lab**
Advised by Lace Padilla
- Developing uncertainty visualizations for dimensionality reduction
 - Surveying and synthesizing machine learning literature
- 2024 - 2025 **Independent Researcher**
Advised by Venkatesh Potluri and Jennifer Mankoff
- Developed [MatplotAlt](#), a Python library for adding accessible text descriptions to matplotlib figures
 - Evaluated template and LLM-based methods for generating data visualization descriptions
 - Presented work at EuroVis 2025 in Luxembourg City
- 2022 - 2024 **Undergraduate / Graduate Researcher, ARK NLP Group**
Advised by Suchin Gururangan and Noah A. Smith
- Developed methods for updating language models to new time periods without additional training
 - Analyzed how language model weights change based on the age of training data
 - Released over 500 time-specific models for future study, and presented work at ACL 2024 in Bangkok
- 2021 - 2022 **Research Assistant, Steinmetz Lab + Technician, International Brain Lab**
Advised by Daniel Birman and Nicholas Steinmetz
- Developed [interactive visualizations](#) for large-scale neural data in Unity and Python, which were later [featured on CNN](#)
 - Implemented pipelines to replay recorded mouse neuron activity during tasks

Awards

- 2022 **Mary Gates Research Scholarship (\$5000)**
Awarded by the University of Washington to support undergraduate research
- 2021 **Paradise Scholarship (~\$4000)**
Awarded to Robinson Center students for academic achievement and service
- 2021 **Phi Beta Kappa Honor Society**

Teaching

Spring 2024 **TA, CSE 546: Graduate Machine Learning**

- Grading, helped develop course syllabus and one out of three main assignments
- Led an info session on clustering and dimensionality reduction

Winter 2023 **TA, CSE 163: Intermediate Data Programming**

- Grading, rubric design
- Led two sections a week and helped develop course infrastructure

Fall 2023 **TA, CSE 442: Data Visualization**

- Grading, rubric design, co-led a lecture on D3

Service

2018 - 2025 **Volunteer Advocate, Teen Feed**

Helped provide services and community for youth experiencing homelessness in Seattle